

D689

Literacy Assessment and Interventions

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A school with a new reading coach gives every K-3 student a one-minute letter-sound and oral reading measure during the first three weeks of September to flag who may be at risk. The measures are provided free by the state. What type of assessment is this?

- A. Universal screening.
- B. Progress monitoring.
- C. Outcome assessment.
- D. Diagnostic assessment.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A second grader reads a grade-level passage for one minute during a quiet morning in the library. He reads 112 words and makes 8 errors, and his teacher notes he self-corrected 3 times. What is his score in words correct per minute?

- A. 112
- B. 104
- C. 120
- D. 101

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A fourth grader who plays violin in the school orchestra reads a 200-word passage aloud and makes 16 errors. The passage is about ocean tides. At what level is this passage for her?

- A. Frustration (8% accuracy).
- B. Independent (92% accuracy).
- C. Instructional (92% accuracy).
- D. Frustration, because any error over 10 means frustration.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student will read a 150-word passage. What is the greatest number of errors she can make and still read at the independent level (95% or higher)?

- A.** 8
- B.** 142
- C.** 15
- D.** 7

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A third grader in a Tier 2 fluency group, which meets in a new portable classroom, has six weeks of progress-monitoring data. Her last four weekly scores all fell below the aim line. Her attendance has been perfect. What should the team decide?

- A.** Move the group back to the main building.
- B.** Keep going unchanged, since six weeks is never enough to decide.
- C.** Raise her goal.
- D.** Change or intensify the intervention.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student's last four progress-monitoring scores are all above the aim line. What is the usual decision?

- A.** Change the intervention because it is not working.
- B.** Raise the goal to keep the target ambitious.
- C.** End all support at once.
- D.** Make no decision until the year ends.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A second grader using a colorful new intervention program scored 40 WCPM at baseline and 64 WCPM twelve weeks later. His teacher has 22 students. What is his rate of improvement?

- A.** 2.0 WCPM per week
- B.** 24 WCPM per week
- C.** 5.3 WCPM per week
- D.** 0.5 WCPM per week

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student's baseline is 50 WCPM. The team expects growth of 1.5 WCPM per week for 20 weeks. What goal should they set?

- A.** 80 WCPM
- B.** 30 WCPM
- C.** 71.5 WCPM
- D.** 20 WCPM

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A fifth grader who is the class line leader has received Tier 2 decoding support in a group of five, three times a week for 30 minutes, for ten weeks. Data show little growth even though the program was delivered as designed. What is the best next step?

- A.** Return him to Tier 1 only.
- B.** Call it Tier 3 but teach the same lessons at a faster pace.
- C.** Provide Tier 3 support: one-on-one or a group of two or three, daily, longer sessions, planned from diagnostic data.
- D.** Keep the same Tier 2 group and add a take-home worksheet.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A fourth grader who loves graphic novels reads 55 WCPM with 82% accuracy. Most errors are on vowel teams and multisyllable words. She reads in a classroom decorated with student art. Which intervention best targets her need?

- A.** Repeated timed readings to raise her speed.
- B.** Comprehension strategy lessons on main idea.
- C.** Explicit decoding instruction on vowel teams and syllable division, then practice in text with those patterns.
- D.** More graphic novels for independent reading.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

At a conference in the school's newly painted library, a parent sees that her child scored at the 45th percentile on a national norm-referenced reading test. The parent, who is an engineer, asks what it means. What is the correct explanation?

- A.** Your child answered 45% of the questions correctly.
- B.** Your child is failing, since anything under the 50th percentile is failing.
- C.** Your child scored better than 55% of students.
- D.** Your child scored as well as or better than about 45% of students in the comparison group.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which assessment is criterion-referenced?

- A.** A test reporting each student's national percentile rank.
- B.** A phonics check where reading at least 18 of 20 short-vowel words shows mastery.
- C.** Every classroom test, since all tests compare students.
- D.** An intelligence test with standard scores.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A school ~~with a new reading coach~~ gives every K-3 student a one-minute letter-sound and oral reading measure during the first three weeks of September to flag who may be at risk. ~~The measures are provided free by the state.~~ What type of assessment is this?

Target word: assessment purpose **Decides:** Brief, given to all, to flag risk.

A	Correct	Brief measures for everyone to identify who may need support.
B	Adjacent category	Tracks response to intervention over time, often weekly.
C	Inverted operation	Given at the end of the year to judge results, not at the start to flag risk.
D	Confusion set	Diagnostic tests are longer and pinpoint specific skills for students already flagged.

2. Answer B Concept 2

A second grader reads a grade-level passage for one minute ~~during a quiet morning in the library.~~ He reads 112 words and makes 8 errors, ~~and his teacher notes he self-corrected 3 times.~~ What is his score in words correct per minute?

Target word: compute WCPM **Decides:** 112 – 8; self-corrections are not errors.

A	Dropped element	Total words read; drops the errors.
B	Correct	112 words – 8 errors = 104 WCPM.
C	Inverted operation	Adds errors instead of subtracting.
D	Camouflage	Subtracts the 3 self-corrections, which count as correct.

3. Answer C Concept 3

A fourth grader ~~who plays violin in the school orchestra~~ reads a 200-word passage aloud and makes 16 errors. ~~The passage is about ocean tides.~~ At what level is this passage for her?

Target word: reading level from accuracy **Decides:** $184 \div 200 = 92\%$.

A	Inverted operation	8% is the error rate, not accuracy.
B	Confusion set	Right percent, wrong band; independent is about 95% and up.
C	Correct	$(200 - 16) \div 200 = 92\%$, within 90–94%.
D	Absolute language	Levels depend on the percent, not a fixed error count.

4. Answer D Concept 3 • transfer

A student will read a 150-word passage. What is the greatest number of errors she can make and still read at the independent level (95% or higher)?

Target word: solve for maximum errors **Decides:** $150 \times 5\% = 7.5$, so at most 7 whole errors.

A	Dropped element	Rounds 7.5 up and drops the check; 8 errors falls below 95%.
B	Inverted operation	Solves for words correct, not errors.
C	Wrong stem number	Uses the 10% frustration cutoff instead of 5%.
D	Correct	7 errors $\rightarrow 143 \div 150 \approx 95.3\%$; 8 errors $\rightarrow \approx 94.7\%$.

5. Answer D Concept 4

A third grader in a Tier 2 fluency group, ~~which meets in a new portable classroom~~, has six weeks of progress-monitoring data. Her last four weekly scores all fell below the aim line. ~~Her attendance has been perfect.~~ What should the team decide?

Target word: decision from the graph **Decides:** Four consecutive points below the aim line.

A	Camouflage	The room does not explain the lack of growth.
B	Absolute language	The decision rule is designed for exactly this amount of data.
C	Inverted operation	That is the rule for points above the aim line.
D	Correct	Four points below the aim line signal the current plan is not working.

6. Answer B Concept 4 • transfer

A student's last four progress-monitoring scores are all above the aim line. What is the usual decision?

Target word: decision for points above the line **Decides:** Four consecutive points above the aim line.

A	Inverted operation	That is the rule for points below the line.
B	Correct	Growth is outpacing the plan.
C	Absolute language	Exit decisions also require meeting benchmark, not just four points.
D	Dropped element	Drops the purpose of frequent monitoring.

7. Answer A Concept 5

A second grader ~~using a colorful new intervention program~~ scored 40 WCPM at baseline and 64 WCPM twelve weeks later. ~~His teacher has 22 students.~~ What is his rate of improvement?

Target word: compute ROI **Decides:** Gain of 24 over 12 weeks.

A	Correct	$(64 - 40) \div 12 = 2.0$.
B	Dropped element	The total gain; drops the division by weeks.
C	Wrong stem number	Divides the final score (64), not the gain, by 12.
D	Inverted operation	Divides weeks by gain.

8. Answer A Concept 5 • transfer

A student's baseline is 50 WCPM. The team expects growth of 1.5 WCPM per week for 20 weeks. What goal should they set?

Target word: solve for the goal **Decides:** Goal = baseline + rate $\times$ weeks.

A	Correct	$50 + (1.5 \times 20) = 80$.
B	Dropped element	Expected gain only; drops the baseline.
C	Inverted operation	Adds 1.5 and 20 instead of multiplying.
D	Wrong stem number	The number of weeks.

9. Answer C Concept 6

A fifth grader ~~who is the class line leader~~ has received Tier 2 decoding support in a group of five, three times a week for 30 minutes, for ten weeks. Data show little growth even though the program was delivered as designed. What is the best next step?

Target word: intensifying support **Decides:** Non-response to well-delivered Tier 2 calls for Tier 3 intensity.

A	Inverted operation	Reduces support when he needs more.
B	Confusion set	Relabeling is not intensifying.
C	Correct	Tier 3 raises intensity and individualizes instruction.
D	Dropped element	Drops real changes in group size, time, and focus.

10. Answer C Concept 7

A fourth grader ~~who loves graphic novels~~ reads 55 WCPM with 82% accuracy. Most errors are on vowel teams and multisyllable words. ~~She reads in a classroom decorated with student art.~~ Which intervention best targets her need?

Target word: intervention matched to the deficit **Decides:** Accuracy below 90% with patterned decoding errors points to decoding.

A	Adjacent category	Fluency practice on inaccurate decoding builds speed on errors.
B	Confusion set	Comprehension is not the root need.
C	Correct	Fixes the root decoding gap that is slowing her down.
D	Camouflage	Uses her interest; does not teach the missing patterns.

11. Answer D Concept 8

At a conference ~~in the school's newly painted library~~, a parent sees that her child scored at the 45th percentile on a national norm-referenced reading test. The parent, ~~who is an engineer~~, asks what it means. What is the correct explanation?

Target word: interpret a percentile **Decides:** Percentile rank compares to the norm group.

A	Confusion set	Percentile is not percent correct.
B	Absolute language	The 45th percentile is within the average range.
C	Inverted operation	Reverses the comparison.
D	Correct	Percentile rank shows standing relative to peers.

12. Answer B Concept 8 • transfer

Which assessment is criterion-referenced?

Target word: identify criterion-referenced **Decides:** Compares performance with a set standard.

A	Inverted operation	Norm-referenced.
B	Correct	Judged against a fixed standard, not other students.
C	Absolute language	Many classroom tests measure mastery of a standard.
D	Adjacent category	Norm-referenced and not a literacy mastery measure.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	6	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	3	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	3	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	11	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	5	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	3	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Four purposes of assessment	Screening flags risk for everyone; diagnostic pinpoints specific skill gaps; progress monitoring tracks response to instruction often; outcome measures judge year-end results.	Using a brief screener as if it were diagnostic.	Who takes it, how long it is, and how often it is given.
2	Words correct per minute	WCPM = words read in one minute – errors; self-corrections count as correct.	Counting self-corrections as errors, or reporting total words read.	An oral reading fluency record with words, errors, and self-corrections.
3	Accuracy and reading levels	Accuracy = words correct ÷ total words; about 95%+ is independent, 90–94% instructional, below 90% frustration.	Reporting the error rate as accuracy, or mixing up the level bands.	A passage word count and an error count.
4	Aim-line decision rules	When about four consecutive progress-monitoring points fall below the aim line, change the intervention; when four fall above, raise the goal.	Waiting indefinitely, or raising the goal when data are below the line.	A graph with several points above or below the aim line.
5	Rate of improvement	ROI = (current score – baseline) ÷ weeks; goal = baseline + (weekly growth × weeks).	Dividing the final score, not the gain, by weeks.	A baseline, a later score, and a number of weeks.
6	Intensifying from Tier 2 to Tier 3	Tier 3 increases intensity: smaller groups or one-on-one, more frequent and longer sessions, and instruction individualized by diagnostic data.	Calling the same Tier 2 lesson with extra worksheets Tier 3.	A student not responding to Tier 2 despite good data.
7	Match the intervention to the deficit	Drill down to the root skill: low fluency with low accuracy points to decoding, which must be taught before fluency practice will help.	Assigning repeated reading for speed when the real problem is decoding.	Slow reading paired with accuracy below 90% and patterned word errors.
8	Norm- vs. criterion-referenced scores	Norm-referenced scores compare a student with a peer group (percentile rank); criterion-referenced scores compare with a set standard. A percentile is not a percent correct.	Reading “45th percentile” as “45% correct.”	A percentile or a mastery cutoff.

Course scope (public description): Literacy Assessment and Interventions is an essential course for candidates to enhance their skills in identifying and addressing literacy challenges in all student populations, including students with dyslexia, through Tier 1, Tier 2, and Tier 3 multi-tiered systems of support and assessment (MTSS). This course reviews the science of reading associated with a wide range of assessments and techniques used to evaluate reading, writing, speaking, and listening skills. Students learn to administer and interpret assessments, using the data to identify specific literacy needs and learning gaps. A significant focus of the course is on designing

and implementing targeted intervention strategies to support student learning in areas, such as phonemic awareness, phonics, fluency, comprehension, and vocabulary development. By exploring and implementing actionable steps to monitor student progress, candidates gain expertise in improving literacy outcomes for all learners.